IMCSF meets every Sunday evening at the First Unitarian Universalist Church of San Francisco, 1187 Franklin at Geary Blvd.

6:30—7:00 Social time
7:00—7:45 Silent meditation
7:45—7:55 Break
7:55—8:55 Announcements, dharma talk, and discussion

Visit us online:

www.sfinsight.org
(official IMCSF website)
http://groups.yahoo.com/group/IMCSF
(online sangha)

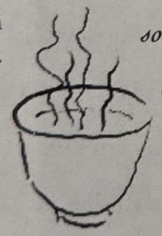
For more information about IMCSF's activities at the Unitarian Church, call Roxanne Worthington at 415.661.3036.

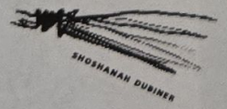
Beginning orientation

Second Sunday of the month, 6:00 p.m. A brief introduction for people who are new to vipassana meditation practice and/or new to our sangha. Led by a senior student.

Monthly potluck

First Sunday of the month, 5:30 p.m., in the church's Fireside Room. A time to socialize and enjoy vegetarian dishes.





Our newsletter

Sangha News is published four times a year. It features events within the sangha and the greater dharma community, an article by our teacher, Eugene Cash, and voices of sangha members. You can download the latest issue of *Sangha News* from our website (www.sfinsight.org). If you'd like to be notified via email whenever a new issue becomes available, join our Yahoo Groups site (http://groups.yahoo.com/group/IMCSF).

About our teacher

Eugene Cash is the founding teacher of the Insight Meditation Community of San Francisco. He teaches at Spirit Rock Meditation Center in Marin County, 25 miles north of San Francisco, and leads intensive meditation retreats internationally. His teaching is influenced by both Burmese and Thai streams of the Theravada tradition, as well as Zen and Tibetan Buddhist practice. He is also a teacher of the Diamond Approach, a school of spiritual investigation and self-realization developed by A. H. Almaas.


FLORA DAVIS

IMCSF
P.O. Box 475536
San Francisco, CA 94147

The Insight Meditation Community of San Francisco



IMCSF is dedicated to offering the teachings of the Buddha as they develop in the West. Our specific orientation is toward intensive householder (lay) practice. We offer a weekly group meditation and dharma talk (lecture), plus classes, meditation retreats, and other events as a community of spirit devoted to the embodiment of awakening in our lives. We meet every Sunday evening at the First Unitarian Universalist Church of San Francisco, 1187 Franklin at Geary Blvd.

Meditation

We practice a style of meditation known as *vipassana*, or insight meditation. Also translated as mindfulness, *vipassana* means to see deeply, or clearly, penetrating and illuminating reality. The practice of vipassana or mindfulness offers a way to radically transform our vision, understanding, and engagement of and with our human life.

BEGINNING MEDITATION CLASSES

Periodically, IMCSF holds beginning meditation classes at the Unitarian Church. The classes are generally held one night a week for five weeks, and culminate with a daylong meditation retreat. The classes are led by a senior sangha member who has completed the Community Dharma Leader program at Spirit Rock Meditation Center. Please check our newsletter or website for an up-to-date schedule. For more information, contact Roxanne Worthington at 415.661.3036.

Dana practice

Dana means generosity. The Buddha's teachings are considered priceless and are offered freely, so that all may benefit. In return, those who value the teachings support them with dana (a donation). Dana practice gives practitioners an opportunity to express their gratitude for the teachings and to cultivate the joy of giving.

At our weekly meetings, we provide two baskets for dana offerings: a basket for IMCSF (which covers expenses such as rent and our newsletter) and a basket for the teacher. The suggested donation is $1-$2 for IMCSF, and $5 or more for the teacher.

defining buddha dharma sangha

Considered precious, these are the Three Jewels, or Three Refuges, of Buddhism. *Buddha* refers both to the historical Buddha and to the wise and compassionate Buddha nature within each of us. *Dharma* refers both to the teachings of the Buddha and to the universal truths of human life. *Sangha* means community and can refer to any group of Buddhist practitioners: monks, nuns, or householders (laypeople). The Buddha placed great importance on the company of like-minded companions.



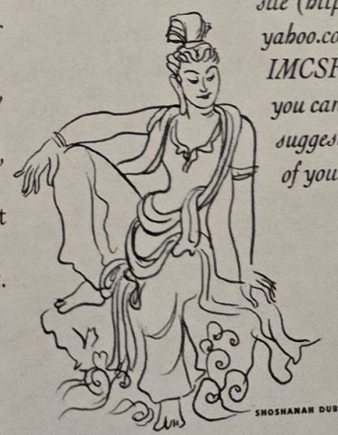
The Buddha invited all to "come and see for yourself" the path that leads to freedom. We invite you to join in this rich adventure and investigation of the dharma.

Kalyana mitta groups

Kalyana mitta means spiritual friends. These small groups (typically 6 to 12 people) meet to study and share experiences in support of each other's practice. The meeting format usually includes a short meditation, an opportunity to talk about one's personal practice, and a discussion about an agreed-upon topic or book. Some groups have a specific orientation (our sangha, for example, has had a women's group and a 12-step group). For more information, call our Kalyana Mitta Coordinator, Tim Wicks, at 415.821.2569, or email him at timothywicks@earthlink.net.

OTHER WAYS TO GET INVOLVED

Sangha members frequently engage in outside activities and service projects. Past activities have included "byatras" (meditative group bike rides), the compilation and sale of a sangha cookbook to fund residential retreat scholarships, participation in programs sponsored by the Unitarian Church (such as Broadway Sing-Along Night), transforming discarded Altoids tins into beautiful "travel altars," and assorted fundraising projects for an AIDS-related community outreach program founded by Buddhist friends in South Africa. To stay abreast of current activities, check our website (www.sfinsight.org), our newsletter (available online), or our Yahoo Groups site (http://groups.yahoo.com/group/IMCSF), where you can also post suggested activities of your own.



SHOSHANAH DUBINER